LOK SABHA

Oakridge JMUN 2026

The House of the People

Agenda: Discussion on strengthening India's education system through greater uniformity in school education and comprehensive reforms in public examinations

CAR KIA
Jubilee Hills | HiTech City | Financial District

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1. Letter from the Executive Board

Respected Members,

We, as the Executive Board for the Lok Sabha simulation at OAK JMUN 2026, wholeheartedly welcome each and every one of you to this unconventional, yet most important, committee.

With the help of this Background Guide, we as the Executive Board aim to give you a starting point on the agenda: a base for your research and, most importantly, a base for the Lok Sabha, to provide clarifications.

Delegates, although the committee might be unconventional, it is still one of the most relevant and most important committees in the modern era.

This is where your research comes in, and we would like to reiterate that this Background Guide is only to be used for reference. Please don't limit your research to, or consider it done after going through, the Background Guide's contents.

This is simply a starting point. Looking forward to hosting the best committee at OAK JMUN. The one, the only, the Lok Sabha.

Regards,
Manan Garg (Chairperson)
Vedh (Vice Chairperson)
Reyaan Aditya (Scribe)

2. Rules of Procedure

The rules of procedure and committee flow on the first day of the conference will be explained by the Executive Board.

3. Preamble to the Constitution of India

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a **SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC** and to secure to all its citizens:

JUSTICE, social, economic and political;

LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship;

EQUALITY of status and of opportunity;

and to promote among them all

FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation;

IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949, do **HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION.**

"Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic" and "unity and integrity of the Nation" were substituted by the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, Sec. 2 (w.e.f. 3.1.1977).

4. Agenda Overview

Agenda: Discussion on strengthening India's education system through greater uniformity in school education and comprehensive reforms in public examinations.

4.1 Introduction

India has one of the world's largest school systems, with children studying in government, private, aided, and community schools. The central question is whether India needs more common standards across states and schools, while also changing

exams so that they test understanding rather than memorisation. The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 supports universal access to schooling and a shift towards competency-based assessment.

4.2 Understanding the Agenda

The agenda concerns the education students receive in school and the examinations used to assess their learning or determine admission to further education.

Uniformity can refer to several different things: common minimum school facilities, comparable learning standards, similar examination procedures, or the same curriculum and textbooks. These are separate issues. Schools can follow similar learning standards while teaching different languages or including regional history and culture.

India has national and State education institutions, different school boards, and constitutional protections relating to language and minority educational institutions. Education is included in the Concurrent List of the Constitution, allowing both Parliament and State legislatures to make laws on the subject, subject to the constitutional division of powers.

Public examinations also serve different purposes. School board examinations assess achievement in school subjects and provide qualifications. Entrance examinations select candidates for particular courses or institutions. A problem with school teaching, an error in marking, and a leaked entrance examination paper therefore involve different responsibilities and legal rules.

4.3 Role of Centre and States

Education is on the Concurrent List, meaning both the Union and state governments have roles. The Centre can provide policy direction, funding, national frameworks, and assessment standards. States run schools, recruit many teachers, and adapt education to local needs.

5. Uniformity in School Education

5.1 Meaning of Uniformity in School Education

Uniformity does not necessarily mean every school must teach in exactly the same way. It can mean common learning goals, similar quality of teachers, comparable infrastructure, and fair opportunities for all children.

- A common curriculum framework can ensure that a child in one state learns core skills similar to a child in another state.
- Uniformity can reduce differences between urban and rural schools, and between government and private schools.
- However, India is diverse, so complete uniformity may ignore local languages, cultures, and needs.

5.2 The 5+3+3+4 School Structure

NEP 2020 replaced the older 10+2 structure with a 5+3+3+4 design, covering ages 3 to 18. It gives greater importance to early childhood education, foundational literacy and numeracy, middle school, and secondary education.

Stage	Ages	Main focus
Foundational	3–8 years	Play-based learning, early language and numbers
Preparatory	8–11 years	Basic reading, writing, maths, discovery
Middle	11–14 years	Subject learning, critical thinking
Secondary	14–18 years	Deeper subjects, skills, career preparation

5.3 Foundational Literacy and Numeracy

Many children attend school but still struggle with basic reading and mathematics. ASER 2024 found that only about 27% of Class 3 children could read a Class 2-level text, and only about 33.7% could do subtraction. This makes foundational learning a major issue. If children do not learn to read and calculate early, they fall behind in later classes.

5.4 Common Curriculum and National Curriculum Framework

The National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE) provides guidance on what children should learn and how they should be taught. NEP 2020 envisaged a new framework developed by NCERT to support a more holistic and competency-based education system.

A common framework can help maintain minimum quality across states. But states should also have flexibility to include regional history, local languages, and local examples.

5.5 Medium of Instruction and Mother-Tongue Education

NEP 2020 encourages education in the mother tongue or local language, especially in the early years. The idea is that children understand concepts better when taught in a language they speak at home.

Arguments in favour

- Children learn faster in a familiar language.
- It protects regional languages.
- It can reduce fear and confusion in early schooling.

Arguments against

- Parents may prefer English for higher education and jobs.
- Migration can make a single local language difficult.
- Schools may lack teachers and books in local languages.

6. Reforms in Public Examinations

6.1 Board Examinations: Frequency and Flexibility

NEP 2020 proposes allowing board exams up to two times in a school year: one main exam and one improvement exam, if a student wishes.

This can reduce the pressure of a single "make-or-break" examination. It may also give students a second chance to improve their score.

Arguments in favour

- Reduces exam stress.
- Gives students a chance to improve.
- Encourages continuous learning.

Arguments against

- May increase coaching culture.
- Can create pressure to keep appearing for exams.
- Requires strong exam systems and extra resources.

6.2 Entrance Examinations and Coaching Culture

Entrance exams for universities and professional courses often push students towards private coaching. This can make education expensive and unfair for students who cannot afford coaching.

Reform ideas include:

- School exams that better prepare students for higher education.
- Reducing repetition of entrance exams.
- Common entrance tests with transparent syllabi.
- Free official preparation material and mock tests.

7. Topics of Debate and Special Emphasis

7.1 Institutional Accountability

Definition and Relevance

Institutional accountability means that an organisation is answerable for its decisions, its use of money, and the performance of its duties.

In education, the institutions involved include schools, education departments, school boards, examination agencies, and organisations hired to provide examination services. Their responsibilities can include appointing teachers, maintaining facilities, preparing question papers, supervising examination centres, evaluating answers, and publishing results.

Accountability connects the agenda's stated standards with the organisations responsible for meeting them. A requirement concerning school facilities involves the authority responsible for providing and maintaining those facilities. An examination failure involves identifying which organisation controlled the stage at which the problem occurred.

Legal

The Constitution divides education responsibilities between the Union and the States. The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, commonly called the RTE Act, establishes duties concerning elementary education, including school standards, teachers, and monitoring.

Examination misconduct falls under a different set of provisions. The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 addresses specified misconduct in examinations conducted by authorities covered by the Act. Its coverage does not automatically extend to every school examination.

Administrative responsibility and criminal liability are also different. An organisation may have to explain a failure in supervision. Whether a person committed a criminal offence requires consideration of the relevant law and evidence.

Political

Education involves decisions at several levels of government. National institutions work on curriculum frameworks, assessment standards, and specified national examinations. States administer their education systems through their departments and other authorities. School boards have responsibilities within their respective examination systems.

The National Council of Educational Research and Training, or NCERT, develops educational resources and curriculum frameworks. PARAKH, established within NCERT in February 2023, works on assessment standards and comparability across school boards. Its work includes examining how different boards assess learning.

The National Testing Agency, or NTA, conducts specified entrance and other examinations. It has a different role from a school board and does not conduct every school examination in India.

These arrangements create several forms of public responsibility. Ministries answer questions about government policy and administration. Examination authorities explain decisions about their tests. Investigating agencies examine suspected

offences, while courts consider legal challenges. Each process concerns a different part of the education system.

Social

Students and families experience accountability through everyday contact with institutions. Examples include receiving information about teacher availability, understanding an examination result, or obtaining a response to a complaint.

The RTE Act provides for School Management Committees in covered schools. Their functions include monitoring the school and the use of grants. The Act includes requirements for parental participation and women's representation, although the arrangements do not apply identically to every category of school.

Information about school performance also takes different forms. A report showing the number of teachers describes staffing. Attendance records show whether those teachers were present. Examination results show assessed performance. These records answer different questions about how an institution functions.

Economic

Schools and examination agencies use public funds, grants, fees, and other permitted sources of income. Expenditure can include salaries, buildings, learning materials, examination centres, printing, transport, technology, and security. Financial accountability concerns how money is received, allocated, and spent. Educational accountability concerns the services delivered with those resources. The amount allocated to a programme and the amount actually spent are different figures.

A common school requirement can also involve different costs in different locations. Providing transport to a remote settlement involves different arrangements from serving a densely populated urban area. A school's total budget therefore does not, by itself, explain its facilities, staffing, or the circumstances of its students.

Examples of Different Responsibilities

A school with an unfilled teaching post and a school with an appointed teacher who is repeatedly absent may both experience interrupted teaching. However, the first situation concerns recruitment or deployment, while the second concerns attendance and supervision.

Similarly, an answer being recorded incorrectly and a confidential question paper being disclosed are different examination failures. One concerns the accuracy of assessment records; the other concerns examination security. Their causes, evidence, and applicable procedures can differ.

7.2 Affected Students

Definition and Relevance

Affected students are learners whose education, examination experience, results, or progression is changed by conditions or failures within the education system.

This includes students facing inadequate school facilities or interruptions to teaching, as well as candidates affected by examination errors, postponements, cancellations, or misconduct.

Students taking the same examination do not necessarily have the same preparation or resources. Their circumstances can differ in teacher availability, language of instruction, access to books, internet connectivity, household income, transport, and disability-related support.

The agenda therefore concerns both the conditions in which students learn and the procedures through which their learning is assessed.

Legal

Article 21A of the Constitution provides for free and compulsory education for children aged six to fourteen, in the manner determined by law. The RTE Act provides the legislative framework for this right. These provisions concern elementary education and do not create an automatic right to admission to a particular university or professional course.

The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 addresses inclusive education. Its provisions include suitable modifications to examinations, such as extra time and scribe facilities. A scribe is a person who writes a candidate's answers where the applicable arrangements permit this assistance. Eligibility and detailed procedures depend on the relevant requirements.

A complaint about access to elementary education, a request for disability-related assistance, and a challenge to an entrance examination result are consequently different legal matters.

Political

Decisions about school standards, examination timetables, results, and admissions affect different groups of students. A school board's decision concerns candidates within its examination system. A national entrance examination can affect applicants seeking admission across several States.

Students' concerns can reach institutions through complaints, representations to government, parliamentary scrutiny, and court proceedings.

The NEET-UG 2024 litigation is an example. Candidates challenged aspects of the examination and sought different forms of relief, including a fresh examination. The Supreme Court considered both the evidence of misconduct and the consequences of cancelling the examination for the wider group of candidates.

Social

School conditions vary across locations and institutions. The government's summary of UDISE+ 2025-26 reported approximately one lakh schools operating with a single teacher. It also recorded internet connectivity in 67.4% of schools and ramps with handrails in 58.2%. These figures describe school facilities and staffing; they do not establish what resources every student has at home.

Learning levels are another part of students' circumstances. ASER 2024, a rural household survey, found that 23.4% of Class III children enrolled in government schools could read at least a Class II text, compared with 16.3% in 2022. This records an improvement alongside a continuing gap between the class attended and the reading task assessed. The findings concern rural India and a specific measure of basic reading.

Students can also experience examination pressure and uncertainty about results or admissions. A government parliamentary reply in December 2022 described NCERT resources on stress and emotional well-being, along with training for teachers and counsellors. These programmes recognise student well-being as an educational concern, but their existence does not measure the psychological effect of a particular examination incident.

Economic

Education involves household expenses as well as government expenditure. Families may pay for books, uniforms, transport, school fees, coaching, and examination-related travel.

The Comprehensive Modular Survey on Education, conducted during April–June 2025, estimated average household expenditure on school education at ₹2,863 per student in government schools and ₹25,002 in non-government schools during the current academic year. It also reported that 27% of students were taking or had taken private coaching during that year. The survey recorded school education and private coaching expenditure separately.

An examination being held again can involve further travel, accommodation, preparation, and time away from work for an accompanying family member.

There can also be an opportunity cost. This means the value of the next-best activity given up. For example, additional preparation may use time that a student would otherwise spend on another course, employment, or family responsibilities.

These costs vary between households. A student living near an examination centre and a student travelling from another district can face different expenses even when taking the same test.

Different Student Circumstances

Students can be affected in different ways by the same decision. A changed examination date may involve rearranging travel for one candidate and rearranging a scribe or accessible transport for another.

Candidates affected by misconduct also form different groups. Some may have received unauthorised assistance, while others followed all the rules. Among those who followed the rules, some may already have secured a satisfactory result, while others may be challenging an error affecting their own marks.

These differences help explain why examination disputes can involve several distinct claims rather than one shared experience.

7.3 Paper Leaks

Definition and Relevance

A paper leak is the unauthorised disclosure of confidential examination questions or answers before their authorised release.

It can involve selected questions, an entire paper, or an answer key. It is different from the official publication of questions and answers after an examination.

Paper leaks connect directly to the agenda because examinations are used to assess learning and select candidates. Early access to confidential material can give some candidates information unavailable to others.

Public examinations can also experience problems unrelated to a leak. An answer key is the official set of accepted answers; an incorrect key can affect marks even when the paper remains confidential. Marking or recording errors can occur when answers are evaluated, scanned, totalled, or entered into results. Technical failures can interrupt a computer-based test or reduce the time available to candidates.

Grace or compensatory marks are additional marks awarded under the applicable arrangements, for example in response to lost examination time. Disputes can concern who received them and how they were calculated. In NEET-UG 2024, compensatory marks awarded to 1,563 candidates became a separate issue from the paper leak.

Some examinations use different question papers in different sessions. Normalisation is a statistical method used to make scores across sessions more comparable where paper difficulty can differ. The method depends on the examination's published rules. Normalisation is an assessment procedure; concerns about its operation are different from evidence that confidential questions were disclosed.

Legal

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024 came into force on 21 June 2024. It covers examinations conducted by listed or notified authorities, including NTA.

The Act addresses specified unfair means, including question-paper leaks and unauthorised interference with examination processes. It also contains provisions concerning organisations engaged to provide examination services.

Government records confirm that the 2026 amendment was passed by both Houses of Parliament and received Presidential assent. The government's account describes increased penalties, faster investigations, and Special Fast Track Courts for offences under the Act.

An allegation, an investigation, an arrest, and a conviction are different stages. An arrest does not by itself establish guilt.

Political

An examination controversy can involve the examination authority, its supervising ministry, State authorities, police, investigating agencies, Parliament, and courts.

These bodies perform different functions. An examination authority manages the test and its results. Investigators examine suspected offences. Ministers answer questions about government administration. Courts consider legal challenges and the evidence presented to them.

National examinations can affect applicants across several States, while a board examination operates within the relevant board's system. The consequences of a breach depend on both the examination involved and the extent of the misconduct.

Public debate can therefore concern administrative performance, government responsibility, and the legal treatment of particular incidents at the same time.

Social

Examination results influence educational progression and access to further study. A leak can affect candidates who received no unauthorised assistance because their results may become disputed or their admission schedules may change.

The extent of a breach matters. A disclosure to an identifiable group is different from a situation in which the full circulation of the material cannot be established.

Evidence also matters. A message claiming that a paper was leaked is different from a disclosure confirmed through an investigation or court proceedings. Equally, identifying misconduct at particular centres does not automatically establish that every centre was affected.

Economic

Running a public examination involves spending on staff, centres, printing or digital systems, transport, supervision, and evaluation. Holding a replacement examination requires further organisational resources.

Households may face additional costs for travel, accommodation, and preparation. Delayed admissions can also change students' educational plans.

Organised malpractice can involve payments to intermediaries or people who supply unauthorised assistance. Such payments are different from the wider public and household costs of an examination disruption. A payment identified in one

investigation cannot be treated as a national estimate of the economic cost of paper leaks.

8. Historical Cases

8.1 AIPMT 2015

In *Tanvi Sarwal v. Central Board of Secondary Education*, the Supreme Court considered organised malpractice in the All India Pre-Medical and Pre-Dental Entrance Test. The case involved communication of answers to candidates during the examination. The Court set aside the examination and directed that a fresh test be held. This was a case of organised examination misconduct, including the use of electronic communication.

8.2 CBSE Board Examinations 2018

The government confirmed leaks affecting Class XII Economics and Class X Mathematics. The Economics examination was held again on 25 April 2018. A Mathematics retest was not conducted. The government's parliamentary reply also recorded police action and the disaffiliation of the school concerned. The two subjects therefore had different administrative outcomes despite both having confirmed leaks.

8.3 NEET-UG 2024

In *Vanshika Yadav v. Union of India*, the Supreme Court acknowledged leaks at Hazaribagh and Patna. However, on the evidence then available, it found insufficient grounds to conclude that a widespread breach required cancellation of the entire examination.

The Court considered whether candidates who benefited from misconduct could be identified separately from other candidates. It also criticised administrative and security failures. Declining a nationwide retest therefore did not mean that no leak or administrative failure had occurred.

9. Legal Reference

9.1 Constitution of India

Provision	What it says
Article 14	Establishes equality before the law and equal protection of the laws.
Article 21A	Provides for free and compulsory education for children aged six to fourteen, in the manner determined by law.
Article 246 and Entry 25 of the Concurrent List	Provide the constitutional basis for legislative responsibilities in education, subject to specified Union powers.
Article 30	Protects the rights of religious and linguistic minorities to establish and administer educational institutions of their choice.
Article 350A	Concerns State and local-authority efforts to provide facilities for instruction in the mother tongue at the primary stage for children belonging to linguistic minorities.

9.2 Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act 2009

Provision	What it says
Section 19 and the Schedule	Establish norms and standards for schools within the Act's scope.
Section 21	Provides for School Management Committees in covered schools. At least three-fourths of members must be parents or guardians, and at least half must be women.
Section 24	Sets out teachers' duties.
Section 29	Addresses curriculum and evaluation principles for elementary education.

Sections 31 and 32	Concern monitoring children's rights under the Act and handling complaints. Section 32 provides for a local-authority decision within three months and an appeal to the appropriate child rights body.

9.3 Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act 2016

Provision	What it says
Section 16	Addresses inclusive education duties of educational institutions funded or recognised by the appropriate government or local authority.
Section 17(i)	Includes suitable modifications to curricula and examinations, such as extra time, scribe facilities, and specified language-course exemptions. Detailed arrangements depend on applicable requirements.

9.4 Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024

Provision	What it says
Section 3	Identifies specified unfair means, including leaks and unauthorised interference with examination processes. The Act's Schedule and government notifications determine which authorities are covered.

The government's account of the 2026 amendment records imprisonment of five to ten years and a maximum fine of ₹50 lakh for the general unfair-means offence. For offending service providers, it describes a maximum fine of ₹5 crore and an eight-year ban on conducting public examinations.

The government also described two-month investigation and three-month trial requirements, Special Fast Track Courts, and a High Court appeal mechanism. Its August 2026 parliamentary summary confirmed passage by both Houses and Presidential assent.

10. Existing Policies

10.1 National Education Policy 2020

The National Education Policy, or NEP 2020, sets out the government's policy direction for education. It proposes assessments that test understanding, application, and reasoning, with less dependence on memorisation. It also discusses common core learning alongside regional and local content. These are policy objectives; the policy document is not itself an Act of Parliament, and its proposals do not establish that every school or board has implemented the same arrangements.

10.2 National Curriculum Framework for School Education 2023

The National Curriculum Framework for School Education, released in August 2023, translates NEP principles into guidance for curriculum, teaching, and assessment. It sets out learning expectations across stages of schooling and guides the development of syllabuses, textbooks, and classroom practices. A curriculum framework provides an educational reference; the specific syllabus and examination requirements followed by a student depend on the relevant authorities and board.

10.3 PARAKH

PARAKH was established within NCERT in February 2023. It works on standards for student assessment, learning surveys, and comparability across school boards. Comparability concerns how qualifications and assessed learning relate across different board systems. PARAKH's role concerns school assessment; NTA's role concerns the particular examinations entrusted to it. These institutions therefore have different responsibilities within the agenda.

11. Conclusion

Strengthening India's education system requires a careful balance between uniformity and flexibility. Greater uniformity in school education can help ensure that every child, whether studying in a government school in a rural area or a private school in a city, has access to basic learning standards, trained teachers, safe infrastructure, and fair opportunities. A common curriculum framework, shared learning outcomes, and national assessment standards can reduce wide differences in educational quality across states.

However, India's diversity means that uniformity should not mean forcing every school to follow exactly the same language, teaching style, or cultural content. States must retain the freedom to include regional languages, local history, and community-specific needs, while still meeting national standards of quality and equity.

At the same time, public examinations must move away from a system that rewards memorisation and creates excessive pressure. Examinations should test conceptual understanding, problem-solving, creativity, and the ability to apply knowledge in real-life situations. Reforms such as competency-based questions, continuous and formative assessment, flexible board-exam opportunities, transparent entrance tests, and better-designed national assessments can make evaluation fairer and more meaningful.

Ultimately, the goal is not merely to conduct more exams or impose one common system across the country, but to build an education system where learning is meaningful, opportunities are equal, and every child is prepared for higher education, employment, and responsible citizenship. The success of these reforms will depend on strong coordination between the Centre and states, adequate investment in teachers and schools, attention to disadvantaged groups, and a commitment to placing the genuine learning needs of children at the centre of all policy decisions.

12. Research Guidance

12.1 How to Research Further

Start with the Five Wives and One Husband formula: Why, What, When, Who, Where and How. Research your portfolio's stance on the agenda through personal websites, videos of speeches given, or statements laid. Move to your party policy and possible weak points that could be attacked by the opposing candidate. Further move to "oppo research" to garner information for questions or speeches aimed at questioning the validity of the opposing person's statements.

Mention relevant facts, statistics and legislation wherever necessary. The perfect speech in an Indian committee is judged on oratory skills, confidence, legal and factual research mentioned, party or portfolio stance displayed, relevance in committee, political rhetoric and possible solutions.

12.2 Sources for Additional Research

1. Lok Sabha website
2. Rajya Sabha website
3. Standing Committee reports
4. Starred and unstarred questions in Parliament
5. Press Information Bureau (PIB)
6. Press Trust of India (PTI)
7. Rajya Sabha TV channel on YouTube
8. Sansad TV channel on YouTube
9. Government-verified sources

> **Please Note**
>
> All delegates must bring a printout of this document on the day of the conference. This background guide is just for your reference in understanding the agenda and cannot be used as a source or proof in committee.

12.3 Policy Statement

We expect a policy statement from each delegate. A policy statement is written by a member individually, setting out their stance on the agenda. You have to make one single policy statement of at least 500 words covering the agenda, in the name and stance of your allocated portfolio. A sample policy statement is shared below.

Sample policy statement: peach-franni-93.tiiny.site

- AI-generated policy statements and solutions will be discarded.
- Policy statements will be marked, so we hope all members make one.
- It needs to be submitted in the first session of the conference.